



Incident handler's journal

Instructions

As you continue through this course, you may use this template to record your findings after completing an activity or to take notes on what you've learned about a specific tool or concept. You can also use this journal as a way to log the key takeaways about the different cybersecurity tools or concepts you encounter in this course.

Date: 09-07-2026.	Entry: INC -2026-002
Description	This journal entry documents a malware execution incident at a financial services company. It details how a threat actor used a password-protected spreadsheet to bypass security filters, resulting in a malicious payload executing on an employee's workstation.
Tool(s) used	None identified
The 5 W's	• An external attacker sent the malicious email, but the employee unintentionally triggered the breach by opening the attachment and entering the password. • An employee received an email with a password-protected spreadsheet. After entering the provided password to open it, a malicious payload executed on their computer. • The exact time isn't specified in the scenario, but it happened during the employee's shift when they received the email and interacted with the file. • At a financial services company, specifically on the targeted employee's computer.

	• The attacker used a password-protected file to evade or bypass email security filters. The goal was to trick the employee into executing a malicious payload to compromise their machine and potentially the network.
Additional notes	The attacker used a password-protected file to bypass email security scanners, which cannot inspect encrypted attachments. By including the password in the email body, they tricked the employee into unlocking the malware. The company's email gateway does not include a policy to block password-protected attachments from unknown sources.